



How much storage?

Stop guessing how much storage you really need

The easiest way to overpay for cloud storage is to buy it in the middle of a panic. Your phone flashes a warning. Backup stops working. Gmail starts rejecting incoming mail. Photos refuse to sync. Somewhere in the family, someone says, “Just get the biggest plan and finish it.” This chapter is here to stop that nonsense.

Because storage planning is not really about terabytes. It is about file behaviour. What kind of user are you? Do you mostly store documents and a modest photo library, or are you the kind of person whose phone camera roll contains 14,000 photos, 900 videos, five 4K birthday clips, 73 memes you swear are “reference material,” and enough WhatsApp media to qualify as a secondary civilization? Your answer changes everything.

The good news is that the cloud services most Indian readers will consider are transparent enough to make planning easier.

Google says every Google Account gets 15GB of shared storage across Google Drive, Gmail and Google Photos, and that once it fills up, it affects those services together. Microsoft’s India OneDrive plans show a 5GB free tier and then larger Microsoft 365 options, while Apple’s iCloud+ in India starts at 50GB and scales upward. The real problem is rarely “cloud storage is expensive.” The real problem is “nobody checked what was eating it.”

So before you choose 50GB, 100GB, 200GB, 1TB or 2TB, you need to understand what actually consumes storage in modern digital life.

Five biggest storage hogs

Most readers imagine their main storage burden is “photos.” That is often true, but photos are only the start.